within our power to translate our promises into lasting reality. We don't think it is the best system for electing representatives in Parliament for a multiracial country. We believe that, for a multiracial country, there should be a guaranteed representation of those who

compose the multiracial society. If there had been guaranteed representation for the Negros of the United States, the USA would perhaps not be in the trouble they are today. Our relations with India have been quite cordial even before independence and I think they will go on improving after independence. India has had a fairly wide experience of the problems which face us today and, when I visited India, I found our little problems there magnified to cinemascope size which made them more easy to understand.

According to a R&AW officer who had attended the meeting, after Gandhi read the note, he said, 'Ratu Mara was sowing the seed of enmity between Indians and Fijians. The coup did not take place now. In fact, Ratu Mara prepared the ground for a person like Rabuka to strike whenever Indians gained leverage in Fiji politics.'

Shekhawat told me that Mara was completely sold on the Americans and the British and hated the Indians. On the other hand, the Indian government had a very strong emotional connect with the Fiji Indians and they did not want it to be overpowered by diplomatic complexities engendered by the enhanced cultural and trade cooperation between Fiji and its neighbours, Australia and New Zealand.

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